FOR GROWN-UPS NEW TO VIDEO GAMES

THE FIRST-TIMER'S PLAYBOOK

Never held a controller? Start here.
A plain-English guide to **Grand Theft Auto VI**.



LARGE PRINT
NO JARGON

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WELCOME

YOU DON'T HAVE TO BE GOOD AT GAMES.

Maybe the grandkids won't stop talking about it. Maybe you've seen the trailer and thought: *that looks like a film I'd watch*. Either way, this guide assumes you have never played a video game. Not once.

We'll go slowly. One idea per page. Every word that sounds like jargon is explained on page 10.

We'll also be straight with you, including about whether this game is right for you at all.

✓ **Every fact was checked** on 9 November 2026. Where something isn't confirmed yet, we say so.

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01

PART ONE

IS IT FOR YOU?

WHAT IT ACTUALLY IS

Think of a crime drama on TV, except **you** steer the main characters. The story follows **Jason Duval** and **Lucia Caminos** in **Leonida**, a made-up state based on Florida, centred on Vice City, a version of Miami.

Between story chapters you can wander freely: drive the coast, explore towns and swamps, or just watch the sunset.

THE HONEST PART

M **Rated Mature 17+**
by the ESRB, the US age-rating board

If you'd switch off an R-rated crime film, you'll probably want to skip this one.

THE OFFICIAL CONTENT WARNINGS

- Blood and Gore
- Intense Violence
- Strong Language
- Strong Sexual Content
- Nudity
- Use of Drugs and Alcohol
- Mature Humor

$ **"In-Game Purchases"** is on the rating too. The game sells optional extras. You never need them for the story. See page 11.

♥ **Not sure?** Watch a family member play for an evening first. Plenty of people enjoy the story that way, and it costs nothing.

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02 PART TWO YOUR SHOPPING LIST

1 · A CONSOLE

A PlayStation 5 or an Xbox Series X or S. **Not** a PC, phone or older console yet.

2 · A TV

Any TV with an **HDMI** socket. Most TVs from the last 15 years have one.

3 · INTERNET

The game is a **212 GB** download. If your plan has a monthly data limit, check it first.

4 · A FREE ACCOUNT

PlayStation or Microsoft. Free to create during setup. Just an email and password.

WHAT IT COSTS (US LIST PRICES, NOVEMBER 2026)

ITEM	PRICE
The game, Standard Edition	**$79.99** (all you need)
Xbox Series S, 512 GB	$499.99 (tight on space, see page 5)
Xbox Series S, 1 TB	$599.99
Xbox Series X	$749.99 (no disc drive) · $799.99 (with disc drive)
PlayStation 5	About $500 to $900 depending on model. Prices moved several times in 2026, so check on the day.

✓ **Good news: no subscription needed.** You do *not* need PlayStation Plus, Game Pass or GTA+ to play the story. Shops may offer them. You can say no.

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03 PART THREE WHICH CONSOLE?

RULE NUMBER ONE

BUY WHAT THE FAMILY ALREADY HAS.

If the grandkids play on PlayStation, get a PlayStation. You'll have built-in help on speed dial.

PLAYSTATION 5

Popular, plenty of space for the game. A good default.

XBOX SERIES X

Just as capable. Roughly 800 GB usable, so plenty of space.

XBOX SERIES S

Cheapest, but the 512 GB model fills up fast. The game takes over half.

TWO TRAPS TO AVOID

01 **"Digital Edition" means no disc slot.**
That's fine, but then buy the game from the console's own store, not a box from a shop.

02 **Don't buy an older console.**
A PS4 or Xbox One *cannot* play this game. Check the box says **PS5** or **Xbox Series**.

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04 PART FOUR SETTING UP

Set aside an afternoon. Most of it is waiting for downloads, so put the kettle on.

01 Plug in
Power cable to the wall, HDMI cable to your TV.

02 Pick the TV input
Press "Input" or "Source" on your TV remote until the console appears.

03 Charge the controller
Connect it to the console with the USB cable in the box.

04 Follow the screen
Choose language and Wi-Fi. A cable to your router is faster if it reaches.

05 Create your account
Write the email and password on the cheat sheet (page 12).

06 Let it update
The console will update itself. Normal. Don't switch it off.

07 Buy the game
From the console's own store: PlayStation Store or Microsoft Store.

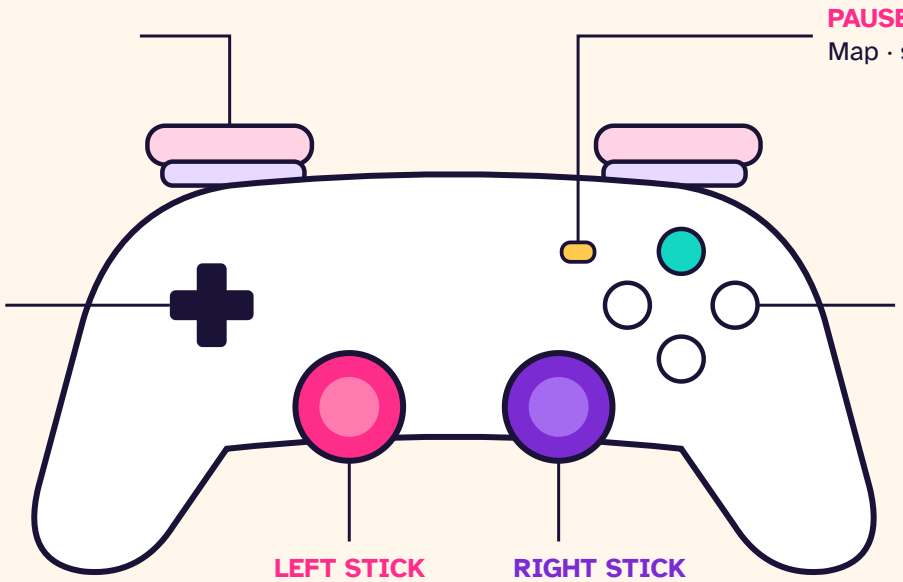
08 Let it download
This can take hours. Leave it overnight in rest/sleep mode.

! **Release day is Thursday 19 November 2026.** You can buy and download from 10 November, but it won't start until release day.

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05 PART FIVE THE CONTROLLER

It looks complicated. It isn't. **Two thumbs do almost everything.**



ON A PLAYSTATION	ON AN XBOX
L2 · R2 (triggers)	LT · RT
L1 · R1	LB · RB
✕ ○ □ △	A B X Y
Options	Menu ≡

Rockstar hasn't published the exact controls yet. This is what each part usually does in games like this. **The game shows you on screen** which button to press, every time it matters.

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06 PART SIX GET COMFORTABLE

Both consoles have an **Accessibility** menu in Settings. Ten minutes there makes everything easier.

YOUR EYES

Turn on **larger text**, **bold text** and **high contrast** in the console's Accessibility settings. Sit at your usual TV distance, with a lamp on.

YOUR EARS

Turn **subtitles on** in the game's settings. If dialogue is hard to hear, look for a separate volume for speech and music.

YOUR HANDS

Both consoles let you **change which button does what**. Xbox's **Copilot** lets a helper's controller work alongside yours.

YOUR STOMACH

Some people feel queasy at first. Sit further back, keep the lights on, and turn down any **camera shake** or **motion blur** option.

! **Feeling dizzy? Stop and rest.** Motion sickness from games is common and usually fades with short sessions. Start with 20 to 30 minutes.

Rockstar hasn't announced the game's own accessibility options yet. The console settings above are available today.

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07

PART SEVEN

YOUR FIRST HOUR

The opening is a guided tutorial. The game teaches you step by step, so you don't need to memorise anything.

1
YOU CAN'T BREAK IT

Nothing you press will damage the console or ruin the game.

2
PAUSE ANY TIME

Press Options/Menu. The world freezes until you come back.

3
FAILING IS NORMAL

Everyone fails missions. The game restarts you just before the tricky bit.

4
FOLLOW THE MARKER

A small map in the corner shows where to go next. Head for the marker.

5
READ THE HINTS

Early on, the game pops up instructions. It teaches you as you go.

6
LITTLE AND OFTEN

Thirty minutes a day beats a four-hour marathon. You'll learn faster too.

♥ **Driving is hard for everyone at first.** Find an empty road and practise gentle pushes on the stick. It clicks within an hour.

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08 PART EIGHT WORDS YOU'LL HEAR

Console
The box under the TV that runs the game.

Controller
The handheld pad you play with.

Save
Stores your progress so you can switch off.

Autosave
The game saving for you, shown by a small spinning icon.

Checkpoint
A restart point partway through a mission.

Mission
A story chapter with a goal.

Cutscene
A short film scene. Just watch.

Open world
A big map you can roam freely.

Mini-map
The small map in the corner of the screen.

Waypoint
A marker you set on the map to guide you.

HUD
The info on the edges of the screen: map, money, health.

Wanted level
Police attention. In past GTA games, shown as stars.

NPC
Any character controlled by the game, not a person.

Patch
A free update that fixes problems.

Pre-load
Downloading the game before release day.

Respawn
Coming back to life after failing.

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09 PART NINE MONEY & SAFETY

! **Big launches attract scams.** There is no "free GTA 6 download", no "early access code", and no "PC version" right now. Anyone offering one is lying.

BUY FROM THE SOURCE

Only the **PlayStation Store**, the **Microsoft Store**, or a shop you already trust.

LOCK PURCHASES

Turn on **"password at checkout"** in your account settings. Both consoles offer it, so nothing is bought by accident.

EXTRAS ARE OPTIONAL

The game sells add-ons and in-game currency. **You never need them** to enjoy the story.

GUARD YOUR LOGIN

Rockstar, Sony and Microsoft will **never** ask for your password by email, text or phone call.

i There's **no online mode at launch**. The game is single-player, so you won't be playing with strangers.

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✂ CUT OUT · KEEP BY THE TV

CHEAT SHEET

Walk / steer	Left stick
Look around	Right stick
Pause & map	Options / Menu
What to press	Watch the screen
Feeling queasy	Pause. Rest.

MY ACCOUNT

Console: _____

Email: _____

Password hint: _____

Helper's number: _____

★ **Release day: Thursday 19 November 2026.** You can't break it. Failing is normal. Little and often.

Sources, checked 9 Nov 2026: Rockstar Support Pre-Load FAQ (date, 212 GB) · ESRB rating and descriptors as reported by Vice and CheatCC · Xbox prices as reported by Variety and Windows Central (Aug 2026 increase) · PS5 pricing as reported by GamesRadar and TechRadar (sources disagree, hence the range) · single-player launch scope as reported by OpenCritic · no confirmed GTA VI accessibility or difficulty options as of publication. *Grand Theft Auto* and *GTA* are trademarks of Take-Two Interactive, used only to identify the game. No game art or logos are used.

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